

OVERVIEW OF OUR 1.5 DAYS TOGETHER

DAY 1

9:00 – 10:00 Session 1: Classroom Management for SLA

10:30 – 12:00 Session 2: Combining SLA Theory with Practice

12:00 – 13:30 lunch

13:30 – 14:50 Session 3: How to Teach Vocabulary Effectively

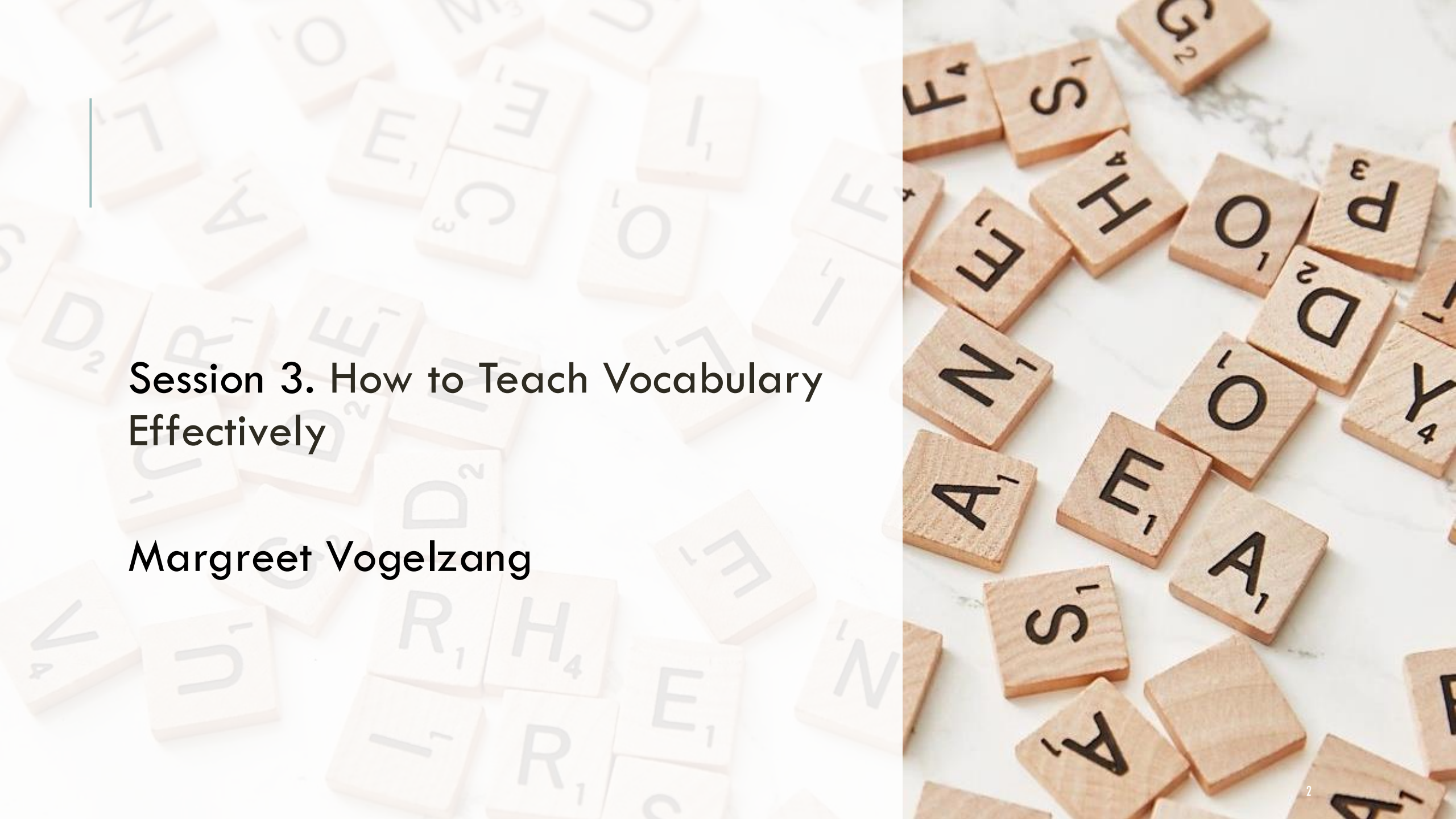
15:10 – 16:30 Session 4: Grammar Teaching

DAY 2

9:00 – 10:00 Session 5: Language Assessment

10:30 – 12:00 Session 6: AI Role-Play Activities in SLA

12:00 – 12:30 Feedback and Evaluation



Session 3. How to Teach Vocabulary Effectively

Margreet Vogelzang

OBJECTIVES



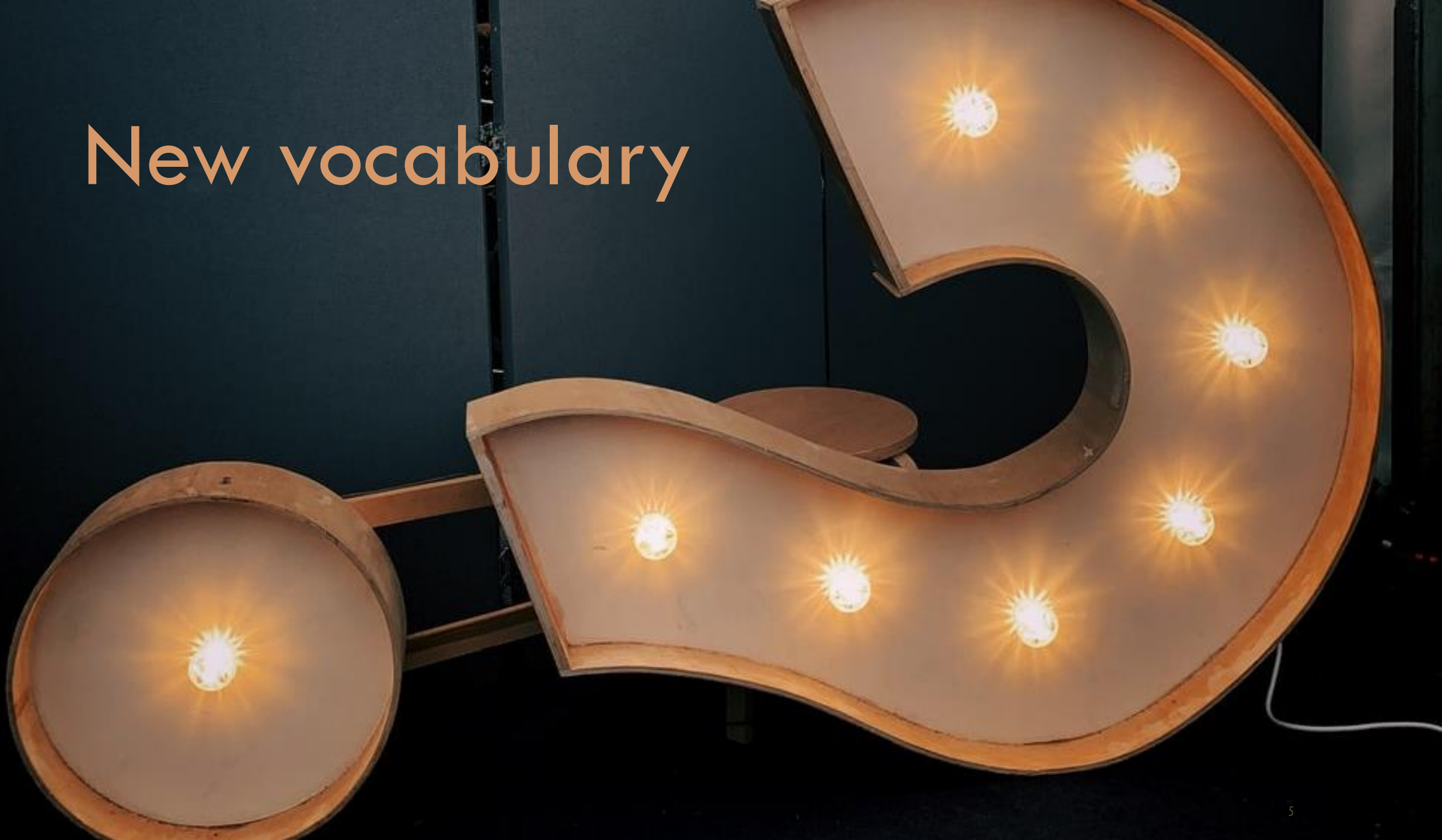
By the end of the session, you will be able to:

- **Learn** how to introduce new vocabulary
- **Learn** how to check learners' understanding
- **Explore** activities that help students practise, review and master vocabulary
- **Use AI** to develop vocabulary exercises

OVERVIEW

- New vocabulary
 - Demonstrate word meaning
 - Concept-checking questions (CCQs)
 - Repetition is key
- Mood-based gap-fill story
- Five finger rule
- Practical exercise

New vocabulary



NEW VOCABULARY: WHAT NOT NOT DO

Why could this cause problems in the classroom?

The teacher asks: “*Do you understand what the word expensive means?*”

The teacher asks: “*What does the word expensive mean?*”





THINK — PAIR — SHARE

Why could this cause problems in the classroom?

NEW VOCABULARY: WHAT NOT NOT DO

The teacher asks: “*What does the word expensive mean?*”

- Not enough vocabulary for a clear explanation
- No meaningful context
- Have the other students actually understood?



NEW VOCABULARY

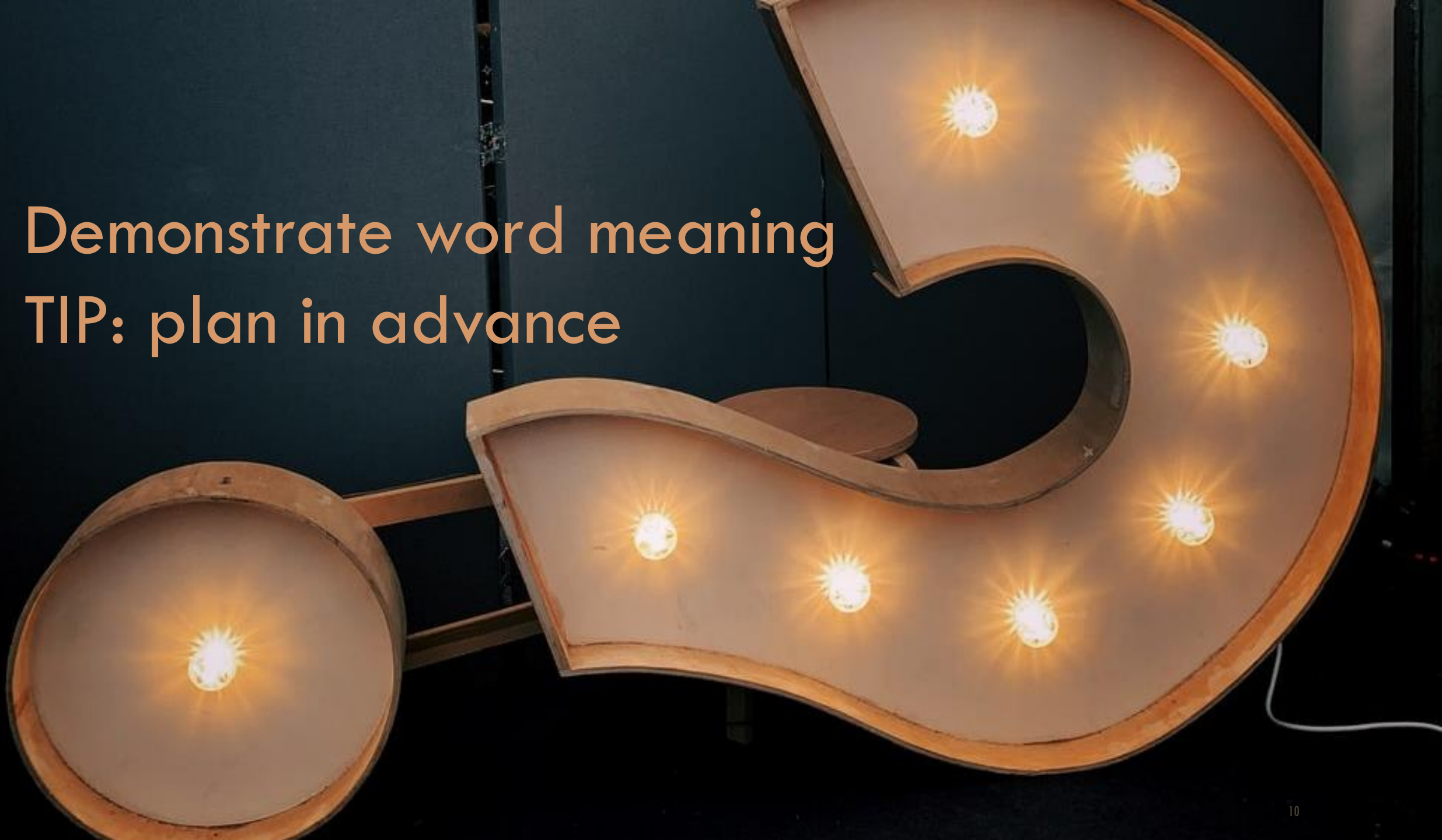
STEP 1: Demonstrate the meaning of the word

Use a picture, example, gesture, situation, synonym, etc.

STEP 2: Check comprehension with concept-checking questions (CCQs)



Demonstrate word meaning
TIP: plan in advance





1. Show an image
The truck/lorry

2. The real object

The highlighter





3. Acting out I am tired

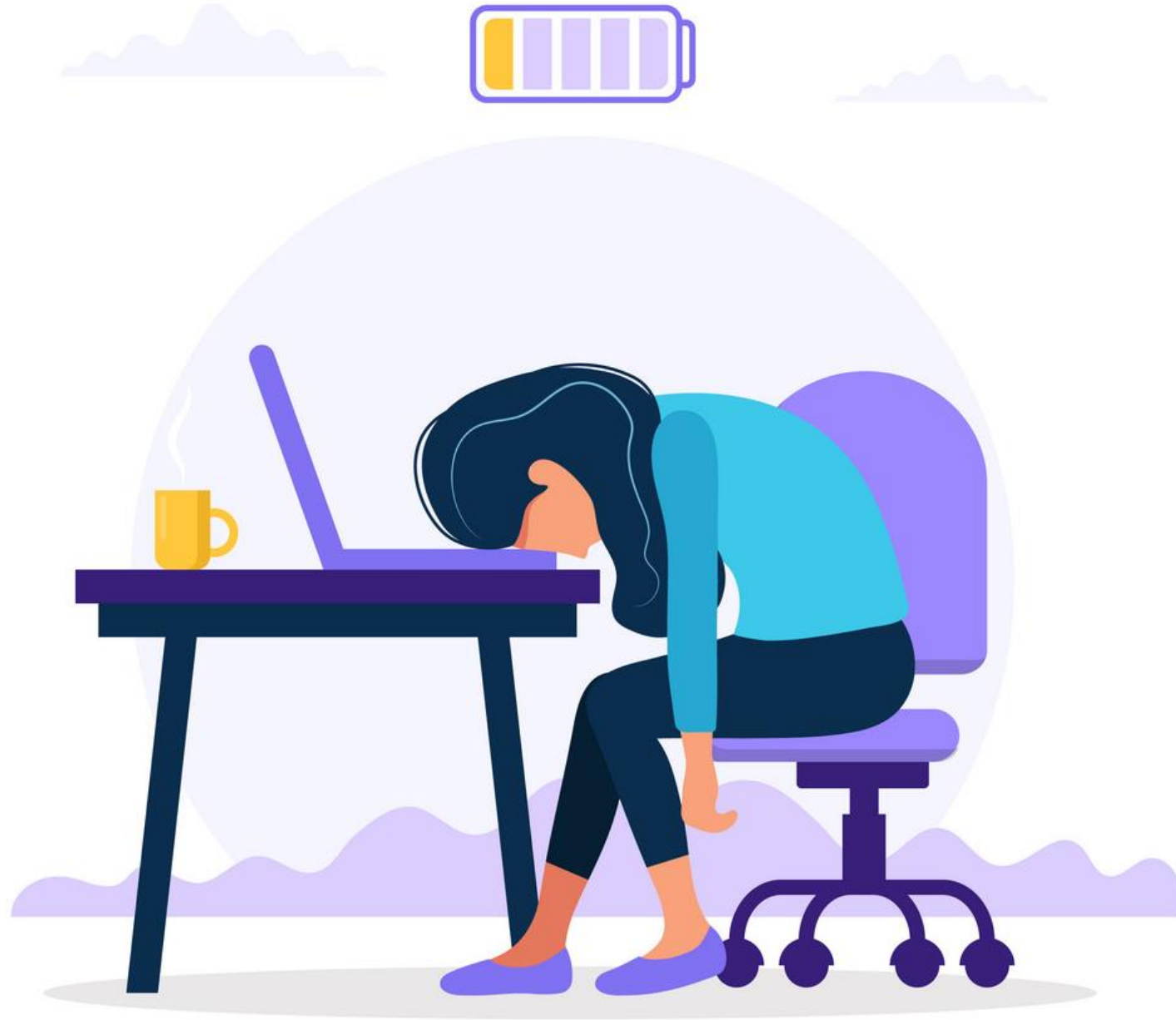


4. Contrasts/ antonyms

The elephant is **big**

The mouse is **small**

5. Synonyms
I'm “*exhausted*”
= I'm “*very tired*”



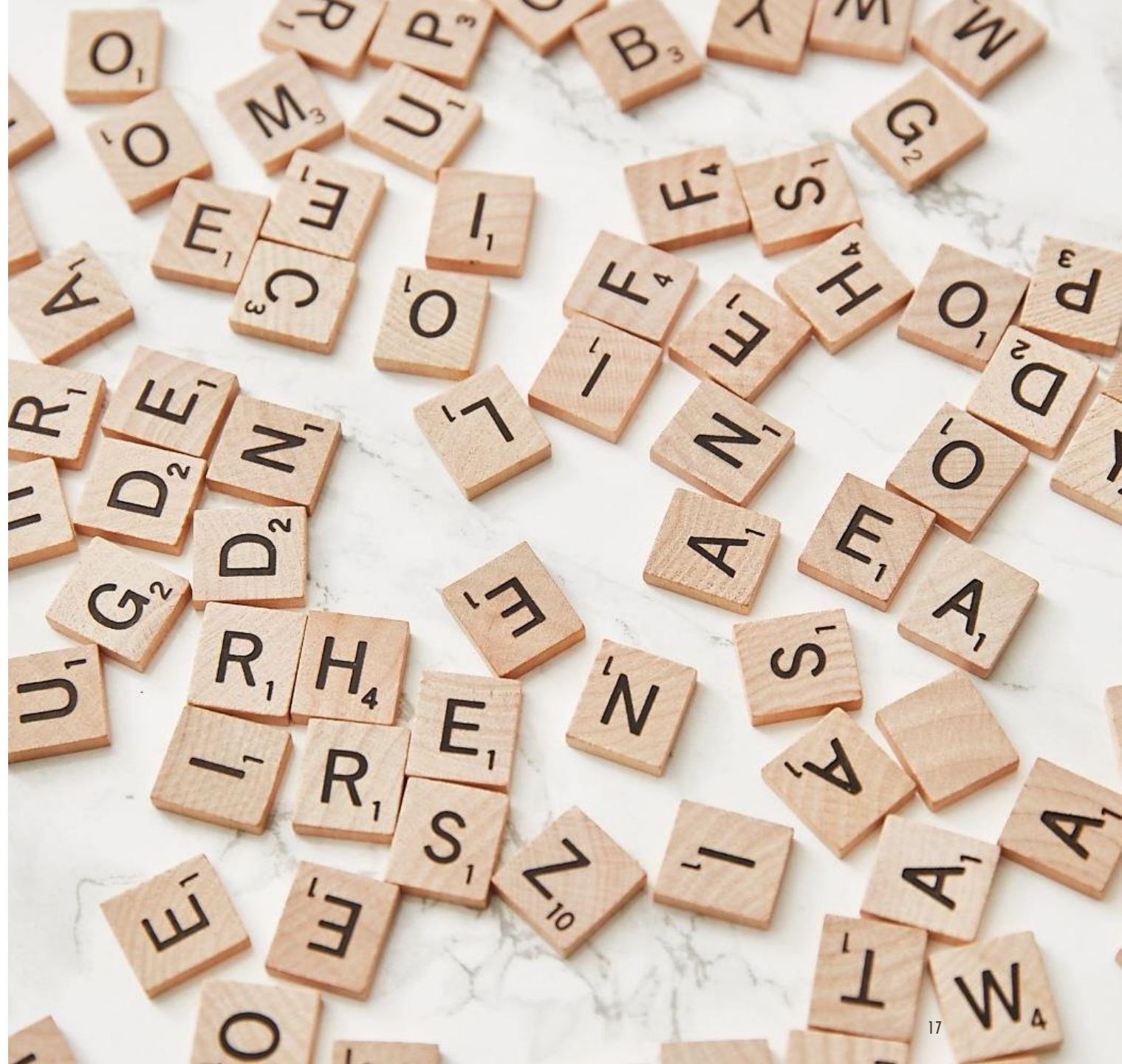


6. A (spoken) gap-fill exercise

*“My son ate two
plates of spaghetti
because he was
very ...”*

DEMONSTRATE WORD MEANING

1. Image
2. Real object
3. Act out
4. Antonyms
5. Synonyms
6. A (spoken) gap-fill



DEMONSTRATE WORD MEANING

- **Work in groups of 3**
- Think of at least **2 ways to demonstrate** each word
- A1 level (beginners)
- **Group 1:** expensive
Group 2: yesterday
Group 3: old



STEP 2

Check comprehension



CONCEPT-CHECKING QUESTIONS

- **Analyse the meaning in context**
- Identify the **core meaning** in simple sentences
- Turn these simple sentences into **questions**
- Keep questions **clear and short**
- With a **clear, short answer**
- **Prepare the questions in advance**



CONCEPT-CHECKING QUESTIONS

“This handbag is very
expensive”

- Do I think the handbag costs a lot of money?
- This handbag costs £10.
Is that expensive?
- That handbag costs £500.
Is that expensive?



CONCEPT-CHECKING QUESTIONS

Work in groups of 3

Create concept questions for the following two phrases:

“I’m **looking forward to** the holidays.” (A2 level)

“I **had** my hair **cut**.” (A2 level)



CONCEPT-CHECKING QUESTIONS

Work in groups of 3

“I’m **looking forward to** the holidays.” (A2 level)

“I **had** my hair **cut.**” (A2 level)

Now let AI do it for you.
Does to do a good job?



REPETITION IS KEY

New words need to be encountered around **7 times** before a learner masters them

Therefore, **repeating and reviewing vocabulary** in class is very important



A person is shown from the chest up, holding an open book. The person's face is partially visible on the left, looking down at the book. The book's pages are open, and some text is visible on the right page. Overlaid on the image in large, white, sans-serif font is the text "mood-based" on the top line and "gap-fill story" on the bottom line. The background is dark and out of focus.

mood-based
gap-fill story



MOOD-BASED STORY

- Work in groups of 3
- Work together to **complete the story**
- Each group will be given a specific **mood/atmosphere** for the story
- You have **5 minutes** to complete the story together
- Afterwards, **one person from each group** will read the story aloud



FILL IN THE GAPS

It was a day. I felt so I went to

When I entered, I was

What I saw there was

My was and was holding a

That was

When I came closer, I saw

Of course,

FILL IN THE GAPS

Group 1: Romantic

Group 2: Funny

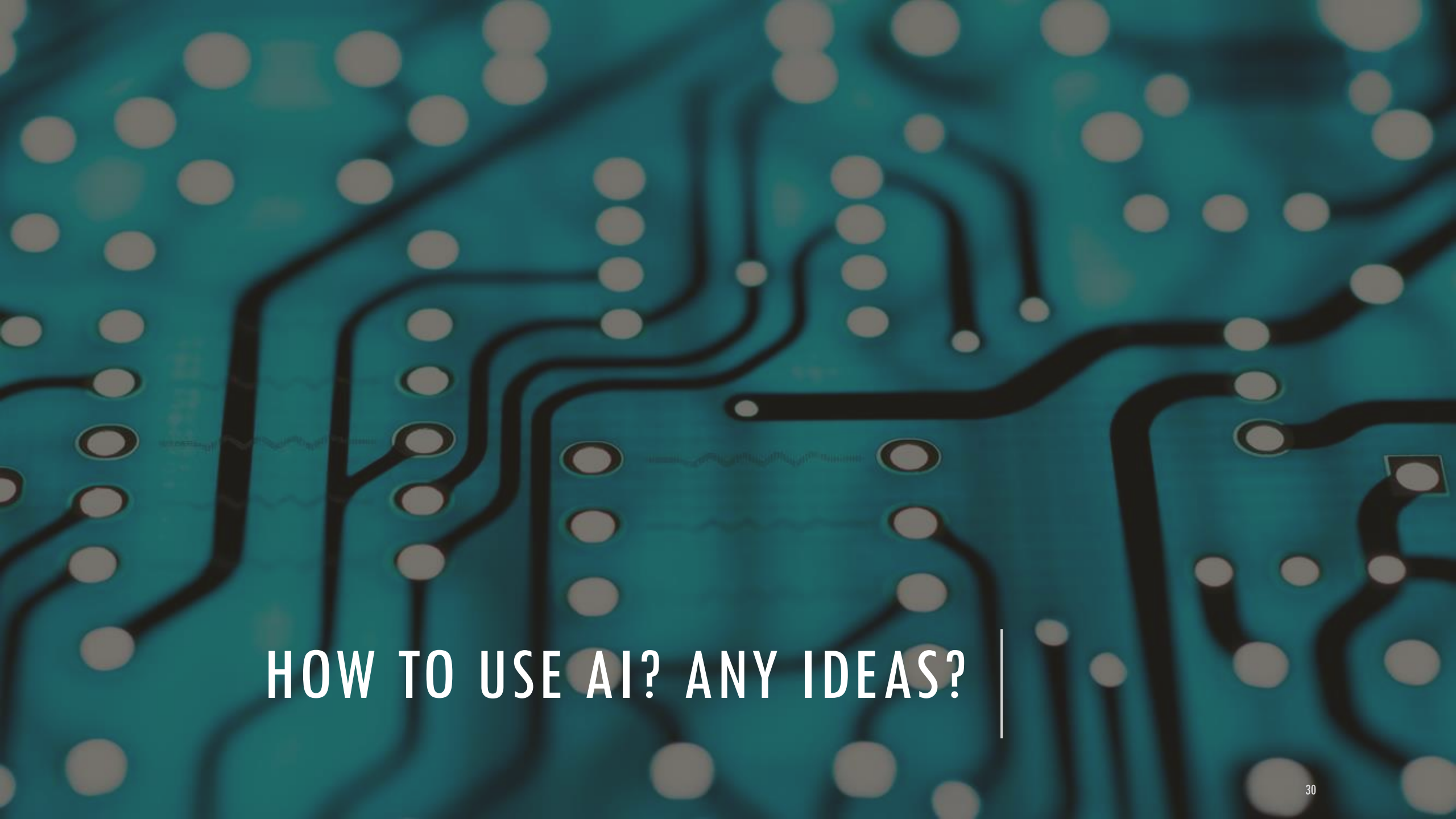
Group 3: Horror

Group 4: Absurd



WAS THIS MOTIVATING?
WHY?



The background is a teal color with a pattern of black circuit lines and numerous light-colored circular bokeh spots. The text is centered in the lower half of the image.

HOW TO USE AI? ANY IDEAS? |

FIVE FINGER RULE

Quick way to judge whether a reading text or book is at an appropriate difficulty level for a learner.

- Read the first page of a text
- **Raise one finger for each word you think they don't know or can't understand**
- Check how many fingers you have raised at the end



FIVE FINGER RULE

Fingers	Meaning
0–1	Too easy
2–3	Just right
4	Challenging
5+	Too difficult



CONSIDERATIONS FOR A TEXT

Linguistic	Non-linguistic
Complex sentences?	Learners' world of experience
Difficult words?	Interest and motivation
How much information?	Organisation of information: layout, formatting
Long sentences?	Abstract ideas
Long text?	

OVERVIEW

- ~~New vocabulary~~
 - ~~Demonstrate word meaning~~
 - ~~Concept-checking questions (CCQs)~~
 - ~~Repetition is key~~
- ~~Mood-based gap-fill story~~
- ~~Five finger rule~~
- Practical exercise

PRACTICAL EXERCISE

Work in pairs

STEP 1: Choose a target population

Who are the learners you'd like to create an exercise for? What is their level?

STEP 2: Select a text

Search online to select a text you think is interesting for the learners
You can also take this from your lesson materials if you have those with you

STEP 3: Use AI to change the text

Use AI to make the text easier or more difficult. Evaluate the outcomes

STEP 4: Use AI to make new exercises

Use AI and try to make at least 3 different types of vocabulary exercises based on the text.
Evaluate the exercises

OBJECTIVES



By the end of the session, you will be able to:

- **Learn** how to introduce new vocabulary
- **Learn** how to check learners' understanding
- **Explore** activities that help students practise, review and master vocabulary
- **Use AI** to develop vocabulary exercises

RESOURCES

<https://www.teachingenglish.org.uk/>

<https://www.usingenglish.com/teachers/>